

## **Refused Request: Mozart Collegium Gala**

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You're an event planning intern at BioGenesis, a large pharmaceutical company located in a beautifully designed building near the Torrey Pines Golf Course in La Jolla. BioGenesis frequently makes parts of this building available to nonprofit and community groups for meetings, receptions and performances. As the event planning intern, your duties include scheduling rooms for these events.

Today you received a room request from a large classical music organization, the prestigious Mozart Collegium San Diego. Jenna Harvey, the Special Event and Fundraising Assistant, used the form on the BioGenesis website to reserve the atrium of the main building—an acoustically perfect, open space with comfortable chairs, a skylight, and plants—for the Collegium's performance gala next summer. The date she proposes will work, but in her description, she mentions that, besides a choral performance by the Collegium, the event will include a silent auction and a fully-stocked hosted bar, including what she calls a "Vodka Luge."

This is a problem. BioGenesis has a strict alcohol policy. First, alcohol can only be consumed in designated areas, and the atrium is not one of these. Moreover, several rules govern the serving of alcohol: even in designated areas, attendees can only be offered wine and bottled beer, food must accompany the drinks, and any alcohol must be served exclusively by a bonded, professional bartender. These stipulations are described on the "Facilities Rental Policy" page of the BioGenesis website (which Ms. Harvey obviously hasn't read).

Send this well-meaning but inexperienced assistant an email with your response, making sure to include an appropriate subject line. In dealing with the situation, remember that BioGenesis has a well-established public mission to support nonprofit organizations in San Diego, including arts organizations like the Mozart Collegium. (In fact, you know the founder of the company loves classical music and are confident she would be interested in opening the atrium for Collegium concerts.)

### **Guidelines**

As you draft the email, make sure you

- review the Bad-News Assignment Description
- use the appropriate approach (direct or indirect)
- refuse clearly and positively
- convey the reasons for the refusal completely and persuasively
- offer an alternative in order to maintain goodwill

### **Resources**

Review specific negative message types throughout Rentz chapter 6, but focus on Learning Outcome 6-3 (pp. 136-46), including all sample messages presented and discussed under that outcome.

### **Contact Information**

Use your campus email address for the email as well as this one for Ms. Harvey: Jenna Harvey (jharvey@mozartcollegium.org)